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ESSnet Big Data II

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https://webgate.ec.europa.eu/fpfis/mwikis/essnetbigdata
https://ec.europa.eu/eurostat/cros/content/essnetbigdata_en

Workpackage WPC

Implementation – Enterprise Characteristics

Deliverable C7: Starter kit for NSIs V.2

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The WPC team has produced the second version of Starter kit for NSIs, intended as an introduction to web scraping for on-line based enterprise characteristics (OBECs), to support producers of official statistics with implementing their own web scraping routines. However, the methods and functions in this Starter Kit most likely need to be adapted to the individual needs and particularities in the respective countries.

The Starter kit for NSIs covers all the needs required to perform the two main tasks, i.e. the search for the URLs of the websites of the enterprises in the population of interest, and the scraping of the contents of these websites. The third module gives an example of the use that can be made of the scraped content, by selecting from each website the links of the social media contained in it. The notebook format allows to understand how to perform each step in the task, giving indications on the required input and permitting to analyze the output.

The Starter Kit has three parts:

- URLsFinder: A library to identify enterprise URLs with the search engine Duck Duck Go.
- URLScraper: Functions to scrape a list of URLs and safe the HTML code in a NoSQL database for later analysis.
- SocialMediaProfiles: A library to identify social media links on enterprise websites.

Each part of the Starter Kit has a Jupyter Notebook (file with .ipynb extension) that serves as a manual on how to use the functions and methods. These manuals are intended for statisticians with little to no programming background and can be viewed on this website. The source code can be consulted by users with a background in programming.

All other details and explanations you can find when you start to reading the Starter Kit for NSIs, V.2 on the following link:
https://github.com/EnterpriseCharacteristicsESSnetBigData/StarterKit.

The release version 2 is available at:
https://github.com/EnterpriseCharacteristicsESSnetBigData/StarterKit/releases/tag/v.2.0